MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION March 2026

Fourth SEMESTER

Answer Scheme

MG4DSCSMG201 -ORGANIZATIONAL BEHAVIOUR

QP Code: 25901541

Duration: 1 hour 30 minutes Maximum Marks: 50

Part A-MCQ

Answer all questions. Each question carries 1 marks

1. Within the scope of OB, what does the 'Individual Level' of analysis study

d). Perception, learning, and motivation

2. "Work Specialization" is the degree to which tasks are subdivided into:

c). Separate jobs

3. Which technique involves members meeting face-to-face to generate ideas without criticism?

a). Brainstorming

4. The 'stability' nature of culture implies that it:

b). Is resistant to change

5. A "Task Group" is characterized as being:

b). Bound by a specific goal

6. Helping employees with "Work-Life Balance" is an opportunity to:

c). Improve staff retention

7. Recognizing collective achievements is a strategy used to:

c). Boost morale and reinforce team identity

8. A "disadvantage" of a Tall Structure (narrow span of control) is:

b). Higher costs

9. Personality is generally defined as being:

a). Stable and enduring

10. A person with a "Proactive Personality" is most likely to:

c). Identify opportunities and take initiative to create change.

Part B- Short Answer

Answer any 10 questions. Each question carries 2 marks

11. Does diverse cultures of individuals pose a threat to organisation's culture? Explain.

Ans: Not inherently. While it can cause initial communication friction, diverse individual cultures enrich an organization. The threat only arises if management fails to build an inclusive, unifying overarching culture.

12. Explain Leadership Style as an element of OB.

Ans: Leadership style is the consistent behavioral pattern a leader uses to direct and motivate others. In OB, it heavily influences employee motivation, job satisfaction, and overall team productivity.

13. Communication fosters better team management. Explain

Ans: Clear communication aligns goals, resolves conflicts early, and builds trust. By ensuring transparent dialogue, managers can delegate effectively, track progress accurately, and keep the team cohesive and motivated.

14. Explain how leadership style influence Organisational Culture

Ans: Leaders shape culture by what they measure, reward, and role-model. An autocratic style fosters a rigid, compliant culture, whereas a democratic style promotes an open, collaborative, and innovative environment.

15. Comment on the role clarity in team and a group

Ans: Role clarity defines specific responsibilities, reducing overlapping work and friction. It transforms a loose group into a high-performing team by ensuring every member knows exactly how they contribute.

16. Write a note on Market Culture

Ans: Market culture is an external-facing corporate culture focused on competitiveness, results, and market share. It prioritizes stability, control, and achieving hard targets, valuing profitability and winning above internal integration.

17. Explain Thinking (T) – Feeling (F) scale in MBTI

Ans: This scale measures how people make decisions. 'Thinkers' rely on logic, objective data, and detached analysis, while 'Feelers' prioritize personal values, human impact, and harmony when making choices.

18. Explain 'Extraversion' in Big Five Model

Ans: Extraversion captures a person's comfort level with relationships. Highly extraverted individuals are assertive, sociable, and energized by social interaction, whereas introverts tend to be reserved, quiet, and deliberate.

19. Write a note on Informational role of manager in OB

Ans: As information nerve centers, managers act as monitors (seeking data), disseminators (sharing information internally), and spokespersons (transmitting information externally) to ensure the organization stays aligned and informed.

20. Write a note on Psychoanalytic (Freudian) Theory

Ans: This personality theory argues that human behavior is driven by the dynamic interaction of the unconscious mind, specifically through three competing components: the primitive **Id**, rational **Ego**, and moral **Superego**.

21. Explain forming stage

Ans: The initial stage of group development where members orientation takes place. It is characterized by high uncertainty, anxiety, and politeness as individuals test boundaries and understand the group's ground rules.

22. Explain how individual perception influences organisational culture.

Ans: Individual perception shapes how employees interpret company policies, leadership actions, and values. If individuals collectively perceive management as fair and transparent, it reinforces a positive, trusting organizational culture.

Part C-Short Essay

Answer any **4** questions. Each question carries **5** marks

23. Write a note on approaches to OB

Ans: Organizational Behaviour (OB) relies on four foundational approaches to understand workplace dynamics:

- **Human Resources (Supportive) Approach:** Focuses on employee growth and development, believing that nurturing talent naturally leads to better performance.
- **Contingency Approach:** Rejects a "one-size-fits-all" management style, arguing that different situational variables require unique leadership responses.
- **Productivity Approach:** Evaluates the efficiency of inputs transforming into high-quality outputs, balancing economic value with employee satisfaction.

- **Systems Approach:** Views the organization as a complex, interrelated set of variables where individual, group, and structural actions continuously influence one another.

24. Founders' Values and Vision plays a significant role in shaping Organisational Culture. Explain

Ans: Founders are the ultimate architects of an organization's initial culture. Because they start with a clean slate, their personal values, beliefs, and vision drive early decision-making, hiring criteria, and operational goals. Founders typically recruit individuals who share their mindset, socializing them into specific ways of thinking and behaving.

Furthermore, the founders' early successes establish "the right way to do things," turning their personal philosophies into institutional norms. Over time, these values become deeply embedded in the organizational fabric, persisting as a defining cultural legacy long after the founders have stepped away from daily operations.

25. Explain the role of specialisation and departmentalisation in Organisational Structure

Ans: While work specialization and departmentalization are classic building blocks of organizational *structure*, they also play a profound, quiet role in shaping a company's internal organizational culture. How you divide work and group people determines how they interact, what they value, and how they perceive their workplace identity.

A. Work Specialization and Culture: Work specialization (the degree to which tasks are subdivided into separate jobs) directly influences employee mindset and social dynamics:

- **High Specialization fosters a Culture of Individual Expertise or Monotony**
- **Low Specialization fosters a Culture of Agility and Collaboration**

B. Departmentalization and Culture: Departmentalization (how specialized jobs are grouped together, such as by function, product, or geography) dictates social boundaries and cultural subcultures:

- **The Rise of Subcultures**
- **The "Silo Mentality" Risk**
- **Cross-Functional Integration**

26. Differentiate between functional and cross-functional teams

Ans: Functional and cross-functional teams differ primarily in their structural composition and operational goals:

- **Functional Teams:** Comprise a manager and subordinates from the same specialized department, such as accounting or human resources. They focus on routine, ongoing vertical tasks within their specific discipline, featuring a clear, traditional hierarchy.
- **Cross-Functional Teams:** Bring together experts from diverse departments (e.g., marketing, R&D, and production) to collaborate on a specific project or solve a unique problem. They operate horizontally, breaking down departmental silos to foster innovation, speed up decision-making, and offer diverse perspectives that a single functional unit cannot provide.

27. An individual's perception is influenced by his cultural and social background. Explain

Ans: Perception is not a passive recording of reality; it is an active process of interpreting sensory input, heavily filtered by an individual's cultural and social upbringing. Cultural background instills specific values, beliefs, and behavioral norms that dictate what a person attends to or ignores. Similarly, social background—including education, social class, and peer groups—shapes personal expectations and biases.

When facing an ambiguous situation at work, two employees will interpret the exact same event differently because their unique background filters cause them to assign meaning based on what their specific culture deems important or acceptable.

28. Group cohesion improves team performance. Elaborate

Ans: Group cohesion—the degree to which members are motivated to stay in a team and align with its goals—acts as a powerful performance multiplier. In highly cohesive teams, members share a strong sense of belonging, which naturally fosters open communication, mutual trust, and a willingness to help colleagues overcome bottlenecks. This alignment minimizes interpersonal friction and destructive conflict, allowing the team to channel its collective energy into productivity.

Furthermore, high cohesion boosts individual morale and commitment, which significantly reduces absenteeism and inspires members to readily accept accountability to avoid letting their teammates down.